Errata

On Guess and Coppock (2020), *British Journal of Political Science* 50(4)

This note lists eleven corrections to "Does Counter-Attitudinal Information Cause Backlash? Results from Three Large Survey Experiments," published in the *British Journal of Political Science* 50(4), doi 10.1017/S0007123418000327: three are participant counts that disagree with the article's own tables; three are Study 3 estimates restated in the text at a precision the tables do not show; one is a table printed in place of another; one is a cross-reference; one is the authors' own corrigendum to Table 1; one is a significance threshold; and the last two are reference-list entries that print a first page in place of a page range. It also carries one entry of a second kind, which quotes a passage and proposes no change to it: a BART proportion that no seed exists to correct. **No correction and no note here changes a conclusion of the paper.** The article's finding, that treatment effects across all three experiments run in the direction of the information rather than against it, is unaffected, and Figure 1 already plots the corrected Table 6 estimates rather than the ones that table prints.

Entry 8 is the correction a separate corrigendum made, at *British Journal of Political Science* 50(4), 1517, doi 10.1017/S0007123419000024, to the standard deviations of Table 1. It is carried here so this note is a complete account of what the published article gets wrong.

Every number in a corrected sentence below is computed from the deposited replication archive (10.7910/DVN/J7WNTM) at the time this document is rendered, including the numbers that were not wrong. The code and output supporting each correction are at github.com/active-maintenance-aec/guess_coppock_2020. Bold marks what has changed.

One published figure is carried and not corrected, as entry 12 below: the article's "93 per cent of subjects have a positive treatment effect estimate when exposed to positive information." The deposited BART script sets no seed, so that figure is a single unseeded draw, and the analysis offers no value it could be corrected to. The full working is in the repository's report.

1. The Study 3 participant counts

> A total of **683** subjects participated in the main survey (287 proponents and **396** opponents).

Corrected:

> A total of **686** subjects participated in the main survey (287 proponents and **395** opponents).

The article's own Table 7 gives the six condition sizes as 117, 116, 112, 118, 121 and 102, which sum to 686, and Tables 8 and 9 report 395 opponents. The deposited Study 3 data hold 686 rows, of which 287 are proponents, 395 are opponents, and four carry no pre-treatment classification and so appear in Table 7 but in neither regression table.

2. The Study 2 participant count

> Of the 1,500 recruited to the main survey, **1,170** participated.

Corrected:

> Of the 1,500 recruited to the main survey, **1,169** participated.

The article's own Table 4 gives the seven condition sizes as 93, 162, 165, 195, 169, 192 and 193, which sum to 1,169, and the deposited Study 2 data hold 1,169 rows.

3. The Study 3 positive information estimate among opponents

> Focusing on the covariate-adjusted models, we estimate that a one-unit increase in positive information causes an average increase in support for capital punishment of 0.015 scale points among proponents and **0.068** scale points among opponents, neither of which is statistically significant.

Corrected:

> Focusing on the covariate-adjusted models, we estimate that a one-unit increase in positive information causes an average increase in support for capital punishment of 0.015 scale points among proponents and **0.074** scale points among opponents, neither of which is statistically significant.

The published sentence gives 0.068 for opponents. The specification the deposit fits, and which Table 8's fourth column reports, gives 0.074. Both round to the 0.07 that Table 8 prints, so the disagreement is visible only at the precision the text itself uses. Dropping race from the covariate set gives 0.086, so the published figure comes from neither specification.

4. The Study 3 negative information estimate among opponents

> Negative information has a strong negative effect among proponents (–0.326, p < 0.01), and a weakly negative effect among opponents (–**0.042**, p = **0.43**).

Corrected:

> Negative information has a strong negative effect among proponents (–0.326, p < 0.01), and a weakly negative effect among opponents (–**0.040**, p = **0.46**).

The published sentence gives –0.042 and p = 0.43. Table 8's own fourth column, and the deposited specification behind it, give –0.040 with p = 0.46. The estimate is not significant at any conventional level on either figure.

5. The Study 3 movement from Con Con to Pro Pro among opponents

> These estimates imply that moving from the Con Con condition to the Pro Pro condition would cause proponents to move $2 \cdot 0.015 + 2 \cdot 0.326 = 0.682$ scale points and opponents to move $2 \cdot \mathbf{0.068} + 2 \cdot \mathbf{0.042} = \mathbf{0.220}$ scale points.

Corrected:

> These estimates imply that moving from the Con Con condition to the Pro Pro condition would cause proponents to move $2 \cdot 0.015 + 2 \cdot 0.326 = 0.682$ scale points and opponents to move $2 \cdot \mathbf{0.074} + 2 \cdot \mathbf{0.040} = \mathbf{0.228}$ scale points.

The published sentence gives $2 \cdot 0.068 + 2 \cdot 0.042 = 0.220$. The arithmetic is right and the two inputs are the ones corrected in entries 3 and 4, so the total moves with them. It is computed from the inputs as printed, as the published total was; from their unrounded values it is 0.227.

6. Table 6 reprints Table 5

Table 6, "Effects of information on favoring minimum wage raise," prints the contents of Table 5 rather than its own. Every cell is identical to Table 5's, and the column header inside Table 6 reads "Dependent variable: T2 Amount" where the table is captioned for the Favor outcome. The text is correct and the table is not: the deposited `GC_Study_2_analysis.R` fits its Table 6 models on `favor_T2_recode`, and Figure 1's "Study 2: T2 Favor" panel plots the estimates below rather than the ones Table 6 prints. The sentence after the table on p. 1506, "With the exception of negative information among opponents, all these coefficients are statistically significant," is false twice of the table the page prints: among opponents positive information without covariates is 0.43 (p = 0.40), and negative information with covariates is –0.70 (p = 0.02). Of the corrected table it holds cell for cell. All twelve information coefficients are correctly signed, and the only two not significant at the 0.1 level are opponents' negative information, –0.02 (p = 0.95) without covariates and –0.13 (p = 0.49) with them. The correction makes the text true. The corrected table follows.

Table 1: Table 6, corrected. Effects of information on favoring minimum wage raise. Dependent variable: T2 Favor. Robust standard errors are in parentheses. The information content of the Placebo condition is coded 0. Covariates include T1 Amount, T1 Favor, age, gender, ideology, party ID, and education. *p < 0.1; **p < 0.05; ***p < 0.01

	Among opponents		Among moderates		Among proponents	
Pos. Info (0 to 1)	0.86***	0.77***	0.56***	0.55***	0.29***	0.35***
	(0.25)	(0.21)	(0.16)	(0.14)	(0.09)	(0.07)
Neg. Info (0 to 1)	–0.02	–0.13	–0.63***	–0.66***	–0.56***	–0.48***
	(0.25)	(0.19)	(0.21)	(0.22)	(0.18)	(0.16)
Condition: Placebo	0.70**	0.34	0.28	0.20	0.01	0.07
	(0.27)	(0.25)	(0.24)	(0.21)	(0.19)	(0.17)
Constant	2.97***	1.72***	5.34***	3.11**	6.34***	2.64***
	(0.11)	(0.53)	(0.08)	(1.22)	(0.05)	(0.53)
Covariates	No	Yes	No	Yes	No	Yes
N	343	343	356	356	470	470
R^2	0.05	0.47	0.07	0.18	0.06	0.33

7. The cross-reference to the binary support results

> In **Table 2**, we turn to the binary gun control support dependent variable, which asks whether respondents support 'stricter gun control laws in the United States.'

Corrected:

> In **Table 3**, we turn to the binary gun control support dependent variable, which asks whether respondents support 'stricter gun control laws in the United States.'

Table 2 is the composite scale table, discussed in the preceding paragraph, which opens with the same words. The binary support models are Table 3.

8. Table 1's standard deviations

> Table 1 prints **the standard errors of the means** in its two SD columns, **(0.00)** as their standard errors, and **no condition label** on its first row.

Corrected:

> **Table 1 as the corrigendum corrects it**: the standard deviation of each outcome in each condition, with its bootstrapped standard error, and the first row labelled Control.

A corrigendum the authors published at *British Journal of Political Science* 50(4), 1517, doi 10.1017/S0007123419000024, corrects Table 1 for a coding error that made the standard deviations and their standard errors inaccurate, and this edition sets its table. The SD columns the page prints repeat the standard errors of the means beside them. The corrected T2 Attitude standard deviations run from 0.99 to 1.02, which bears out the text's "the standard deviations of the outcomes do not appear to vary by treatment condition and are very precisely estimated." The T2 Belief standard deviations do vary, and could not fail to: the outcome is binary, so its standard deviation follows its mean, and means of 0.62 under negative information and 0.72 under positive give standard deviations of 0.49 and 0.45, a difference 3.3 times its bootstrapped standard error. No estimate in the article uses these standard deviations.

9. The significance threshold in the Table 2 note

*p $<$ 0.1; **p $<$ 0.05; ***p $>$ 0.01

Corrected:

*p $<$ 0.1; **p $<$ 0.05; ***p $<$ 0.01

Three stars mark the most significant cells, not the least. Table 3's note, on the facing page, states the same threshold correctly. The starred cells are unaffected: the three-star coefficients in these tables have p-values of 0.0007 and below.

10. The Chipman, George and McCulloch (2007) reference prints a first page in place of a page range

Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems 19, **265**.

Corrected:

Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems 19, **265**–**272**.

Crossref, doi 10.7551/mitpress/7503.003.0038, gives the chapter's pages in Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems 19 as 265 to 272.

11. The Gelman and Loken (2016) reference prints a first page in place of a page range

The Best Writing on Mathematics 2015, **305**.

Corrected:

The Best Writing on Mathematics 2015, **305**–**318**.

Crossref, doi 10.1515/9781400873371-028, gives the chapter's pages in The Best Writing on Mathematics 2015 as 305 to 318.

Carried, and not corrected

The one entry below is different in kind from the eleven corrections in this note. It quotes a passage this edition reprints exactly as the paper published it, and proposes no change to it.

The passage is a proportion the article reports from a BART fit whose deposited script sets no seed. The published figure is one unseeded draw, and the analysis produces no single value it could be corrected to, so any corrected sentence would be the editor's number set in the authors' prose.

It is recorded here because an edition that silently reproduced it would leave a reader unable to tell a faithful reprint from an uncorrected error.

12. The BART proportion of positive treatment effect estimates under positive information

> **93 per cent** of subjects have a positive treatment effect estimate when exposed to positive information and 77 per cent have a negative treatment effect estimate when exposed to negative information.

The deposited BART script sets no seed, so each of the two published proportions is one unseeded draw and the right comparison is against the spread of draws rather than against a point. The maintained rewrite, which pins the sampler to one thread and sets a seed, gives 0.990 for the first, the deposited script with a seed prepended gives 0.990, and a refit at ten seeds runs from 0.9773 to 0.9957, so the published 93 lies below every one of the ten runs. The 77 holds: the rewrite gives 0.787, and the seeds run from 75.6 to 79.5 per cent. The likelier explanation for the gap is the sampler and not the analysis. The archive was deposited when `dbarts` 0.9-3 was current, and its NEWS file records four later repairs to multithreaded sampling, which the deposited script, with no seed and no thread count, is exposed to. That hypothesis is untested. Because no seed exists, no single corrected value can be given, which is why the sentence is carried here and not corrected. No conclusion of the paper changes: a share this near one is stronger evidence that treatment effects run in the direction of the information than 93 per cent would be, so the sentence understates what the analysis found.